

1. Morning coffee before class

Normal path / states: I go to my usual cafe / MODUL Cafeteria → order a coffee → pay → wait around 5 minutes → receive it → leave for class.

Not normal: I order as usual, but after 15 minutes my coffee still hasn't been made maybe due to too many customers.

Quantitative lens: I could measure the waiting time, number of customers ahead of me, number of employees working and compare today's waiting time with the usual.

Qualitative lens: I could see how the delay changes the experience. A normal coffee stop feels easy but the unexpected wait creates stress because I start thinking about being late.

2. U Bahn to university

Normal path / states: I come to the station → wait a few minutes → the U Bahn arrives → I get on → get to my stop → arrive at university on time.

Not normal: The metro suddenly stops between stations for about 15 minutes or pauses somewhere due to unexpected events.

Quantitative lens: I could measure how long the delay lasts, how many passengers are affected and the total increase in travel time.

Qualitative lens: The atmosphere changes as at first everyone is quiet and focused on their own phones but as the delay continues people start looking around, checking the time and becoming impatient.

3. Buying groceries

Normal path / states: I enter the supermarket → choose what I need or check the list → go to the checkout → pay → go home.

Not normal: Only one checkout is open and there is a long queue.

Quantitative lens: I could measure the number of people in the queue, average waiting time, number of open checkouts and how quickly customers go through.

Qualitative lens: I could observe how people react to waiting and whether they become impatient, leave the queue, complain or start interacting with other customers.

4. Studying at the library

Normal path / states: I arrive at the library → find a free floor and a seat → open my laptop and book → study in a hopefully quiet environment → finish my work → leave.

Not normal: A group nearby is talking loudly and making it difficult to concentrate.

Quantitative lens: I could measure how long the noise continues, how many people are involved, how many times I lose concentration and how much longer it takes me to complete my work.

Qualitative lens: I could see how the space changes as I expect the library to feel quiet and focused so the noise feels more disruptive there than it might in a public place.

5. Ordering food in Foodora

Normal path / states: I choose a restaurant in the app → place my order → receive an estimated delivery time → follow the tracking → food arrives → I eat.

Not normal: The app says the food has been delivered but the delivery hasn't come.

Quantitative lens: I could measure the estimated delivery time versus actual delivery time, how long it takes to solve the problem, number of calls or messages needed and whether I receive a refund or not.

Qualitative lens: I could look at the uncertainty created by the situation as normally the tracking system gives me a sense of control but once it is inaccurate, I stop trusting the system and become unsure about what happened to my food.

Scenario to bring to class:

Scenario 5: food delivery

Normal path / states: I order food through an app, receive an estimated delivery time, follow the driver on the tracking screen and expect the food to arrive at my door or the delivery man to call me when he arrives. The process is usually predictable and I rely on the app to tell me what is happening.

Quantitative lens: The deviation occurs when the order is marked as delivered even though I have not received it and haven't received any information from the delivery man. I can measure the promised and the actual delivery time, the additional waiting time, the number of attempts needed to contact the driver or support and the amount of time required to solve the problem / extra additional time.

Qualitative lens: Overtime it leads to loss of trust as before the deviation, the app creates a feeling of certainty because I can see the order status and track its progress. When the screen says "delivered" while there is no delivery, it gives an idea that it disappears somewhere in between these states. A simple dinner order might cause confusion or even frustration because the digital information doesn't match what is actually happening in real time.